

THE OPTIMIZED BITCOIN BUY & HOLD STRATEGY GUIDE

Every Date. Every Price Target.
Exactly When to Buy and Sell.

Backed by 10 years of halving cycle data.

Starting capital: \$1,000

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01 — THE CORE STRATEGY

Bitcoin's halving cycle is the most predictable pattern in all of crypto. Every ~4 years, the mining reward gets cut in half. Every time this happens, the same cycle plays out — a bear market, followed by an explosive bull run, followed by a crash.

This strategy exploits that cycle with three simple rules:

BUY

Buy in the bear market

30 months after each halving. This is when Bitcoin has crashed 75-85% from its all-time high. The media declares it dead. Fear is at maximum. You buy.

SELL

Sell near the cycle top

18 months after the NEXT halving. This is when Bitcoin has pumped 300-1,000% from the bear market low. Euphoria is everywhere. Greed is at maximum. You sell everything.

CASH

Sit in cash

12 months. After selling, you hold cash and wait. Bitcoin will crash again. You don't try to time the exact top or bottom. You just follow the schedule.

Then you repeat. Every cycle. The total cycle length is approximately 4 years (the time between halvings), and you're only actively holding Bitcoin for about 2.5 years of each cycle.

"The hard part was never the math. It's buying when the internet says crypto is dead."

02 — THE HISTORICAL DATA

Here are the exact Bitcoin halving dates and the corresponding buy/sell points used in this strategy. All prices are based on historical data.

Bitcoin Halving Dates

Halving	Date	Block Reward After
1st Halving	November 28, 2012	25 BTC
2nd Halving	July 9, 2016	12.5 BTC
3rd Halving	May 11, 2020	6.25 BTC
4th Halving	April 19, 2024	3.125 BTC

Strategy Buy & Sell Points

Action	Date	BTC Price	Trigger
BUY	May 2015	\$237	30 mo after 1st halving
SELL	January 2018	\$13,500	18 mo after 2nd halving
CASH	Jan 2018 — Jan 2019	—	12 months in cash
BUY	January 2019	\$3,500	30 mo after 2nd halving
SELL	November 2021	\$64,000	18 mo after 3rd halving
CASH	Nov 2021 — Nov 2022	—	12 months in cash
BUY	November 2022	\$16,500	30 mo after 3rd halving
SELL	October 2025	\$108,000	18 mo after 4th halving
CASH	Oct 2025 — Present	—	Waiting for next buy

03 — FULL WALKTHROUGH: 2015 → 2025

Starting with \$1,000 in the 2015 bear market and following the strategy through three complete halving cycles.

CYCLE 1: May 2015 → January 2018

It's May 2015. Mt. Gox collapsed a year earlier. Bitcoin dropped 85% from its 2013 high. The media has declared it dead — again. Nobody wants to touch it.

You buy **\$1,000** of Bitcoin at **\$237**.

You now hold 4.22 BTC.

The 2nd halving occurs in July 2016. You wait. 18 months after that halving — January 2018 — Bitcoin is at \$13,500. Euphoria is everywhere. Your cousin is asking you about altcoins.

You sell everything.

Buy	Sell	Result
\$237	\$13,500	\$56,962

You sit in cash for 12 months while Bitcoin crashes 84%.

CYCLE 2: January 2019 → November 2021

Bitcoin crashed from \$20K to \$3,500. The 2018 bear market wiped out almost everyone. ICOs are dead. The hype is gone. You've been sitting in cash for 12 months — everyone who held through just lost everything they gained.

You buy back in. All **\$56,962** of it. At **\$3,500**.

You now hold 16.27 BTC.

The 3rd halving occurs in May 2020. You wait. 18 months later — November 2021 — Bitcoin is at \$64,000. NFTs are everywhere. Everyone is a genius.

You sell everything. Again.

Buy	Sell	Result
\$3,500	\$64,000	\$1,041,591

You're a millionaire. From \$1,000.

You sit in cash for 12 months.

CYCLE 3: November 2022 → October 2025

FTX collapses. Luna wipes out billions. Bitcoin drops to \$16,500. The internet says crypto is finished. Regulation is coming for everyone.

You buy back in. **\$1,041,591** at **\$16,500**.

You now hold 63.13 BTC.

The 4th halving occurs in April 2024. You wait. 18 months later — October 2025 — Bitcoin is at \$108,000.

You sell. One last time.

Buy	Sell	Result
\$16,500	\$108,000	\$6,817,689

THE FINAL SCORE

\$6,817,689

Three cycles. Six trades. \$1,000 became \$6.8 million.

6,817x return.

04 — LATE ENTRY SCENARIOS

Not everyone was around in 2015. Here's what happens if you started the same strategy at later entry points — still with just \$1,000.

Started in the 2018 Bear Market

You missed the first cycle entirely. You didn't hear about Bitcoin until 2017. You watched it crash all of 2018. In January 2019, you enter with \$1,000 at \$3,500.

Cycle	Buy	Sell	Value
Cycle 2	\$3,500 (Jan 2019)	\$64,000 (Nov 2021)	\$18,286
Cycle 3	\$16,500 (Nov 2022)	\$108,000 (Oct 2025)	\$119,688

\$1,000 → \$119,688 in 2 cycles. 120x return.

Started in the 2022 Bear Market

You just got into crypto. FTX collapsed, Luna wiped out billions, and you're terrified. But you follow the data. November 2022, you enter with \$1,000 at \$16,500.

Cycle	Buy	Sell	Value
Cycle 3	\$16,500 (Nov 2022)	\$108,000 (Oct 2025)	\$6,545

\$1,000 → \$6,545 in 1 cycle. 6.5x return in ~3 years.

Most hedge funds don't return 550% in 3 years. You did it buying one asset and waiting.

05 — STRATEGY vs BUY & HOLD

The most common question: "Why not just buy and hold forever?" Here's the side-by-side comparison at every entry point.

Entry Point	Strategy	Buy & Hold	Advantage
2015 Bear	\$6,817,689	\$286,920	24x
2018 Bear	\$119,688	\$19,429	6x
2022 Bear	\$6,545	\$4,121	1.6x

The strategy beats buy and hold at every single entry point.

Why does the strategy win?

Because it sells near the top and rebuys near the bottom. A buy-and-hold investor rides the entire crash down. The strategy investor is sitting in cash during the crash, then rebuying at a massive discount.

The compounding effect of selling high and buying low — even just once per cycle — is enormous over multiple cycles.

And right now?

Buy-and-holders are watching Bitcoin sit at \$68,000 — down 46% from the all-time high of \$126,080.

The strategy has you in cash. Untouched.

06 — WHERE WE ARE NOW

Current Cycle Position (February 2026)

Milestone	Status
4th Halving: April 2024	COMPLETE ✓
18-Month Sell: October 2025	COMPLETE ✓
Cash Phase: Oct 2025 → Oct 2026	IN PROGRESS
Next Buy Zone: ~October 2026	8 MONTHS AWAY

Bitcoin is currently trading at approximately **\$68,000** — down 46% from its all-time high of \$126,080.

If you followed the strategy, you sold in October 2025 and are currently sitting in cash. The next buy zone is approximately **October 2026** — 30 months after the April 2024 halving.

This is the hardest part of the strategy. Not the buying. Not the selling. The waiting.

What to watch for:

- Bitcoin dropping 60-80% from ATH (historically enters the \$30K-\$50K range this cycle)
- Maximum negative sentiment — "crypto is dead" headlines
- Low trading volume and retail capitulation
- The 30-month mark after the April 2024 halving (~October 2026)

07 — THE EXACT DATES & PRICE TARGETS

Your Actionable Cheat Sheet

Based on the historical pattern, here are the projected dates for the current and next cycle. These are estimates based on the halving schedule.

CURRENT CYCLE (Cycle 4)

Phase	Target Date	What To Do
Sell ✓	October 2025	Sell all BTC. Move to cash/stables.
Cash	Oct 2025 — Oct 2026	Do nothing. Wait.
Buy	~October 2026	Buy BTC with full allocation.

NEXT CYCLE (Cycle 5 — Projected)

The 5th halving is expected around March-April 2028.

Phase	Projected Date	What To Do
Buy	~October 2026	Buy BTC in the bear market.
Hold	Oct 2026 — Sep 2029	Hold through the halving + bull run.
Sell	~September 2029	18 mo after 5th halving. Sell all.
Cash	Sep 2029 — Sep 2030	12 months. Wait for next bear.

Key reminder: These dates are approximate. The halving date is known precisely, but market timing varies. The strategy uses the halving as an anchor, not a guarantee. You may choose to sell slightly earlier or later based on market conditions.

08 — RISK & DISCLAIMER

What Could Go Wrong

→ **The cycle breaks.**

Past performance doesn't guarantee future results. Bitcoin has followed the halving cycle 4 times, but there's no guarantee cycle 5 will play out the same way. Regulatory changes, macroeconomic shifts, or a black swan event could disrupt the pattern.

→ **You sell too early or too late.**

The 18-month post-halving sell target is an approximation. Some cycles peaked earlier, some later. You might leave money on the table or sell after a partial crash.

→ **You can't handle the volatility.**

Even within a winning cycle, Bitcoin can drop 30-40% in a week. If you panic sell during a dip within the bull phase, the strategy fails.

→ **Tax implications.**

Selling triggers capital gains tax. Depending on your jurisdiction, the tax burden on large gains can be significant. Factor this into your planning.

→ **Opportunity cost.**

During the 12-month cash phase, your money isn't growing. Other investments might outperform during that specific window. The strategy optimizes for the full cycle, not every individual month.

DISCLAIMER

This guide is for educational and informational purposes only. It is not financial advice. The historical data presented is accurate to the best of our knowledge, but past performance does not guarantee future results. Bitcoin and cryptocurrency investments are highly volatile and carry significant risk. You could lose some or all of your investment. Always do your own research and consult a qualified financial advisor before making investment decisions. Never invest more than you can afford to lose.

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